Ahmed Fikry SaidAhmed

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Summary

Cybersecurity-focused Computer Science student with hands-on experience in network security, penetration testing, security testing, and secure infrastructure. Gained practical experience across enterprise network security at Crédit Agricole and software testing and security at Vodafone, complemented by technical training with ITI and DEPI. First author of a peer-reviewed IEEE paper on post-quantum security for V2X. Founder of a fintech startup, combining security expertise with product thinking and real-world problem-solving.

Education

B.Sc. Computer Science — Borg Al-Arab, Alexandria | 2026

Egypt-Japan University of Science and Technology (E-JUST)

- Unique program integrating Japanese educational principles.
- Core courses: Data Structures & Algorithms, Cryptography, Network Security, IT Infrastructure, Database Systems.
- Activities: MUN, Enactus-EJUST.

High School — 6th of October City | 2021

STEM High School for Boys

- Activities: TEDx Youth Maadi STEM.

Experience

Software Testing & Security Intern — Jul 2026 – Sep 2026 | Smart Village, Giza

Vodafone Egypt

- Integrated cybersecurity protocols into the software testing lifecycle for the Vodafone e-commerce project, aligning all quality assurance efforts with secure development standards.
- Reviewed the project from a security perspective, identifying potential areas of risk and recommending relevant security testing scenarios.
- Authored a detailed suite of test cases for the Vodafone Egypt e-commerce project, covering both standard workflows and system security vulnerabilities.

IT & Network Security Intern — Aug 2025 – Sep 2025 | Head Office, 5th Settlement, Cairo

Crédit Agricole Egypt Bank

- Configured and troubleshot routers, switches, VLANs, ACLs, and secure protocols while collaborating with senior network security professionals.
- Gained practical experience with FortiGate and Palo Alto firewalls, supporting the team in resolving real-world connectivity and security issues.

Multimedia Designer — Jul 2024 – Oct 2026 | Garden City, Cairo

Boyot

- Produced 15+ animated videos, boosting onboarding success by 25%.
- Edited 20+ marketing and demo videos, driving 3× social media engagement.
- Designed 50+ visuals, growing impressions by 40% in 11 months.
- Created branded decks and docs used with 10+ investors and partners.

Co-Founder & Product Designer — Jun 2023 – Present

Paycoo.app

- Built an offline-capable digital wallet empowering the unbanked in Egypt and beyond.
- Led product design, UX strategy, and full visual identity, achieving 60% higher beta retention than competitors.
- Shaped product vision and developed features like offline payments; co-created Neuropay, ranked among Egypt's top 10 payment tech betas by F6S and PapayaGlobal.
- Pitched to 30+ VCs, incubators, and national stakeholders (incl. the Central Bank of Egypt), securing $35K+ in grants and prizes.

Multimedia & UI/UX Designer — Jan 2022 – Jan 2025

CodeX Technologies

- Led full company rebranding, unifying visual identity across 6+ platforms.
- Designed UI/UX for 3 websites, boosting session time by 32%.
- Produced 4+ motion graphics campaigns, driving 122% reach growth and 60% more interactions in 2 months.
- Delivered 20+ custom assets and 12+ Instagram stories aligned with marketing goals.
- Collaborated with 7+ clients on multimedia and web projects, achieving 100% on-time delivery.

Publications

A. Fikry, E. R. Diab, M. Mohamed, M. M. Atef, K. K. Elfiky, A. S. Mohamed, and S. A. ElSagheer, "A Post-Quantum Aware SCMS for V2X Communications Using Selective Cryptographic Methodology," in *2026 International Conference on Advancements in Smart, Secure and Intelligent Computing (ASSIC)*, Bhubaneswar, India, 2026, pp. 1–6, doi: 10.1109/ASSIC70037.2026.11717405.

- Tackles the emerging threat quantum computing poses to V2X security through a selective post-quantum approach: CRYSTALS-Dilithium-2 and Kyber-768 (ML-KEM) where stronger protection is required, with ECDSA retained for high-frequency V2X messages (CAM/DENM).
- Cut DSRC channel utilization from 161% with full PQC to just 4.3% with the selective approach, within the IEEE 1609.2 framework.

Certifications

Red Teaming Learning Path TryHackMe | 2025

- Focused on simulating real attacker behavior across networks and Active Directory environments, covering reconnaissance, initial access, exploitation, privilege escalation, and lateral movement.

Red Hat System Administration I (RH124) Red Hat

- Hands-on experience configuring and deploying Red Hat Enterprise Linux; managed security, backups, and user administration.

Coursework

Penetration Testing and Vulnerability Analysis 2025

Digital Egyptian Pioneers Initiative (DEPI)

- Web Penetration Testing: discovered and exploited common web vulnerabilities (e.g., XSS, SQLi, CSRF).
- Network Penetration Testing: performed reconnaissance, scanning, and exploitation of network infrastructures.
- Active Directory Attacks: simulated real-world attacks on AD environments, including privilege escalation and lateral movement.

Cybersecurity Summer Internship 2024

Information Technology Institute (ITI)

- Network Fundamentals: strong grasp of core networking concepts.
- Advanced Networking: configured networks, OSPF, and EIGRP using Cisco Packet Tracer.
- Cybersecurity Essentials: learned foundational security principles.
- Ethical Hacking: hands-on with penetration testing, SQL injection, Kali Linux, and Metasploit.
- FortiGate NSE4: practical training in network security.
- Palo Alto: applied firewall configurations and security policies.

Awards & Honors

Graduation Project Fund Recipient (100,000 EGP) 2026

Academy of Scientific Research and Technology (ASRT)

- Awarded competitive funding to develop a secure V2X communication system using post-quantum cryptography, addressing emerging cybersecurity threats in connected vehicles and future smart transportation systems.

2nd Place, Rally Egypt Startup Competition & Special Award from @Shekety 2024

Arab Academy for Science, Technology and Maritime Transport (AAST)

- Competed and emerged as a winner among 1,200 teams across Egypt.

SU Real Life Competition, 2nd Place 2024

American University in Cairo (AUC)

- Delivered impactful solutions at the intersection of fintech and entrepreneurship.
- Combined technical insight with business acumen to drive fintech innovation.

Hack '23 Fintech Track, 1st Place 2023

American University in Cairo (AUC)

- Secured 1st place among 130 teams from 14 countries, earning international recognition for fintech innovation.
- Demonstrated strong fintech development and entrepreneurial leadership.

NASA Space Apps, Local Winner 2020

American University in Cairo (AUC)

Languages & Skills

Languages: Arabic (Native), English (C1), Japanese (JLPT N5)

Skills: Network Security, Penetration Testing, Security Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Post-Quantum Cryptography, Python, Bash, Linux, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Routing & Switching, GitHub